

6 Photos and Videos

Point, shoot and save. Go ahead, explore the camera on your Android and have some fun! Though the camera itself will be different in capabilities on different Android phone but the software powering it will have a few common basic features apart from some useful modifications across the range of handsets available today. Some Android phones might have a dedicated Camera button, most often on the lower-right side, so that it feels like the traditional shutter button of a camera when you hold your phone sideways. In absence of a button on the phone itself, you can simply use the Camera shortcut on your Home Screen. On activating the camera, your screen is a combination of a control panel, generally on the right side, and a viewfinder on the left. In this section we'll see how the Camera app usually works in your Android phone and how you can better organise the Gallery on your phone.

6.1 More on the camera

Your camera will probably have automatic settings that you can use to take quick point-and-shoot photographs and videos along with a number of ways to control exposure settings or may even offer you special effects such as shooting negatives. Android offers a handful of settings you can change with each shot. This appears as white icons overlaid on the image preview. Pressing an icon opens a translucent strip and a small menu pops out for the option you picked. To change the focus mode- automatic or infinity, there is a button on the very top to work with. For most photographers on a phone camera, Automatic will serve just fine but you play with Infinity to see what difference it makes. Below this is a GPS icon that changes accordingly if the phone tries to collect location data to embed in each picture and next to it will be a button to change the white balance for your images. So you can allow the camera's sensors to either adjust automatically or compensate manually for some specific kinds of lightings. Through regular use you'll see that outdoor shooting in Automatic settings is not a problem but while clicking indoors you might see unnecessary tints of blue or orange and in such cases manually adjusting the white balance settings will prove to be a big help.

If your handset has a flash for the camera, its settings will be near the bottom of the view finder when you are using your camera and you can set it to auto, on or off. Also near the bottom will be a zoom setting that can be adjusted